

integer

Any number that does not contain a decimal point and is not written as a fraction (a whole number).

interface

The means by which the user interacts with software or hardware.

IP address

A series of numbers that makes up a computer's individual address when it is connected to the Internet.

library

A collection of functions that can be reused in other projects.

loop

Part of a program that repeats itself (to prevent the need for the same piece of code to be typed out multiple times).

machine code

The basic language understood by computers. Programming languages must be translated into machine code before the processor can read them.

malware

Software that is designed to harm or disrupt a computer. Malware is short for "malicious software".

memory

A computer chip inside a computer that stores data.

module

A section of code that performs a single part of an overall program.

operator

A symbol that performs a specific function: for example, "+" (addition) or "-" (subtraction).

OS

A computer's operating system (OS) provides the basis for other programs to run, and connects them to hardware.

output

Data that is produced by a computer program and viewed by the user.

port

A series of numbers used by a computer as the "address" for a specific program.

processor

A type of electronic chip inside a computer that runs programs.

program

A set of instructions that a computer follows in order to complete a task.

programming language

A language that is used to give instructions to a computer.

random

A function in a computer program that allows unpredictable outcomes. Useful when creating games.

run

The command to make a program start.

server

A computer that stores files accessible via a network.

single-step

A way of making a computer program run one step at a time, to check that each step is working properly.

socket

The combination of an IP address and a port, which lets programs send data directly to each other over the Internet.

software

The programs that run on a computer and control how it works.

sprite

A movable object.

statement

The smallest complete instruction a programming language can be broken down into.

string

A series of characters. Strings can contain numbers, letters, or symbols, such as a colon.

syntax

The rules that determine how a program must be structured in order for it to work properly.

trojan

A piece of malware that pretends to be another piece of software to trick the user.

tuple

A list of items separated by commas and surrounded by brackets.

Unicode

A universal code used by computers to represent thousands of symbols and text characters.

variable

A named place where you can store information that can be changed.

virus

A type of malware that works by multiplying itself to spread between computers.